

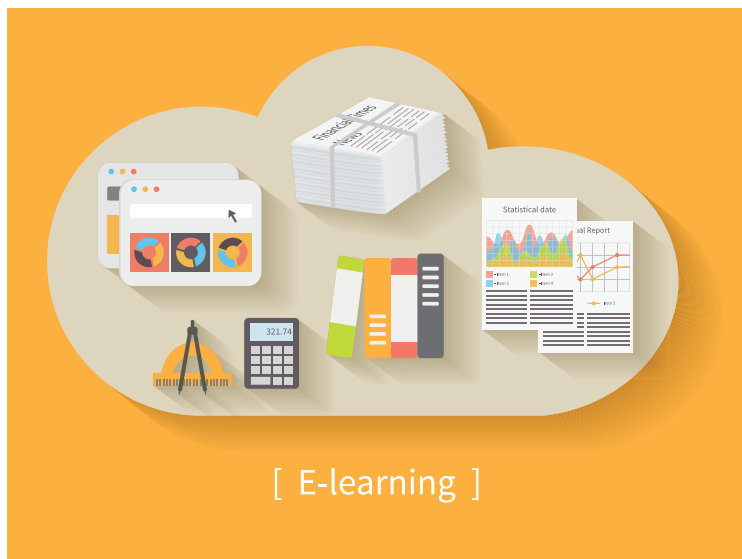
(Programmed Logic for Automated Teaching Operations) was developed for students at the University of Illinois.

PLATO was a CBT Network or a Computer Based Training network and was not only a first when it came to computer based learning but also featured the earliest versions of e-mail, instant messaging, message boards and a few more innovations of that era. It was the first “social computing environment” meaning that it was the first online community. What started off as a room full of computers quickly grew into a thousands of connected computers spanning four decades.

PLATO, over these years grew from a library of educational resources developed specifically for the students of the University of Illinois to other universities in the area and then to schools and universities across the world.

In the '70s when the personal computer began hitting the market was when e-learning started gaining traction but sadly, as computers were a bit of a luxury, not everybody could benefit from what e-learning had to offer. But the good thing was that open universities in the UK began adopting it as a means of distance learning.

The '80s saw institutions like Pearsons introduce 'SuccessMaker', a supplementary curriculum aimed at school students. The curriculum



It's all out there.